

Diseases of the External ear

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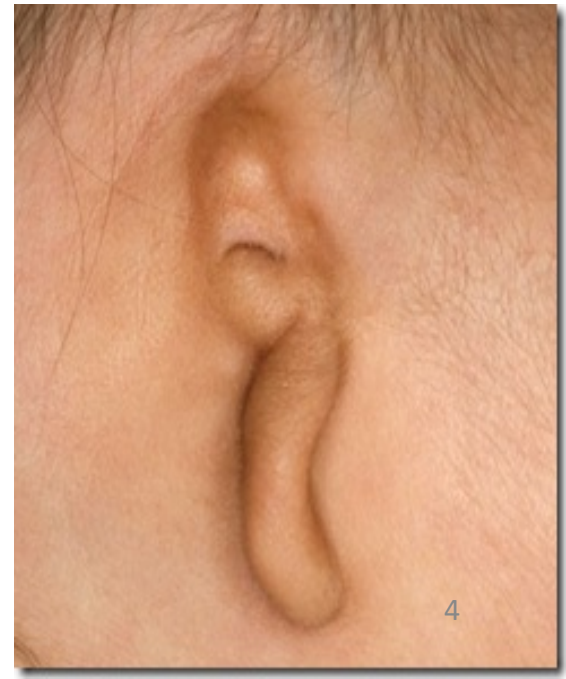
Objectives

This lecture outline the different pathology affecting the external ear, focus mainly on the inflammatory condition.



Auricle

- Congenital
- Trauma
- Inflammation
- tumors





Hematoma



Laceration



Perichondritis



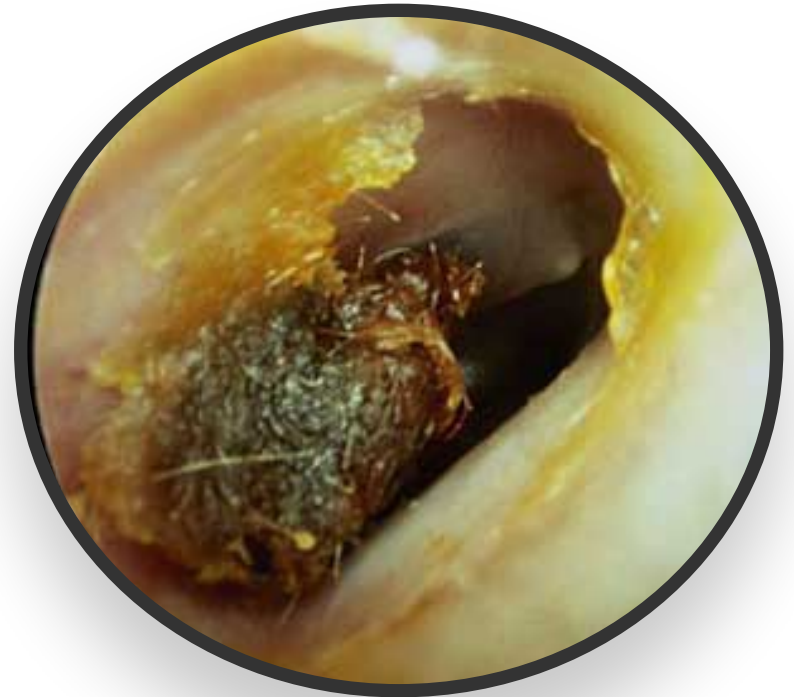
External auditory meatus

- Atresia or stenosis
- Cong. or acquired



wax

- Types , color
- Presentation
- Treatment



Foreign bodies

- Insects
- Hard
- soft



Otitis externa

- Definition
- Causes (1ry , 2ry)
scratching of the ear with dirty fingers or contaminated objects as matchstick or hair grip , faulty syringing , allergy may be the primary factor.
- Types
- Microorganisms

Furunculosis (boils)

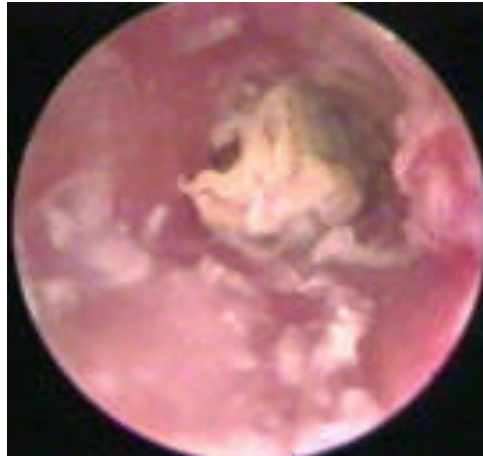
- Definition
- M.O
- Presentation
 - Pain
 - Tenderness
 - Swelling (ant , post.)
 - Lymphadenitis
- Treatment



Diffuse otitis externa

Acute stage

- Heat sensation
- Severe pain
- Discharge
- swollen canal skin
- CD
- Lymphadenitis
- Treatment with dry mopping
+ Ab/steroid



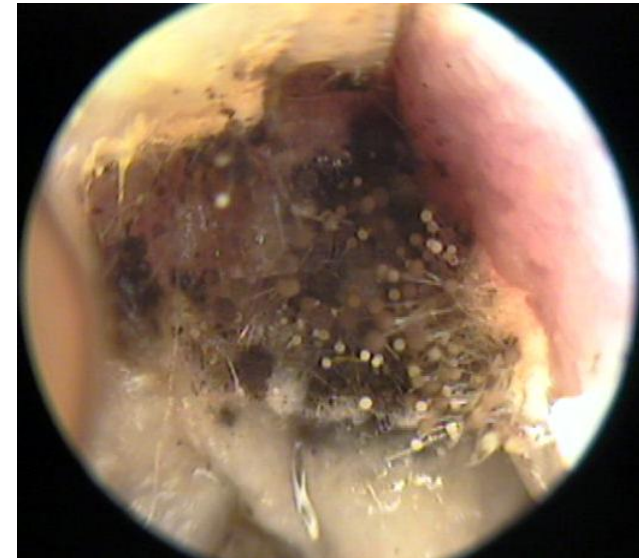
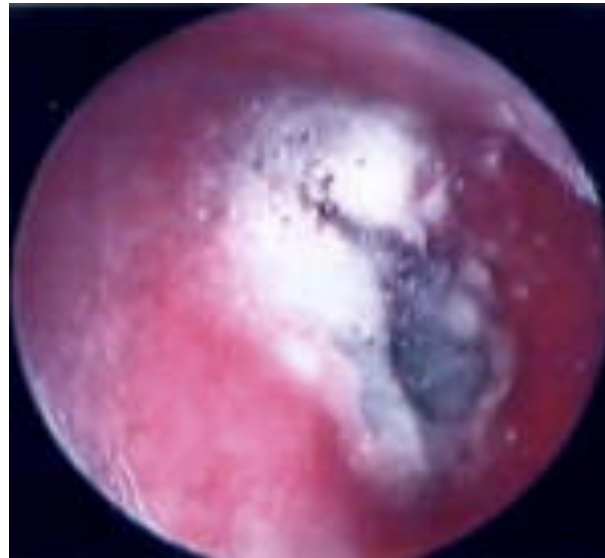
Chronic stage

- Discharge
- Itching
- Thickening & narrowing of the canal
- Congested granular TM surface
- Same + sedation for nocturnal itching

➤ Treatment of both stages generally required thorough & gentle cleansing of external meatus, keeping the ear dry, avoiding trauma by scratching, attention to personal hygiene & treating the associated skin condition.

Otomycosis (fungal infection)

- Types
- Organism
- Presentation
- treatment



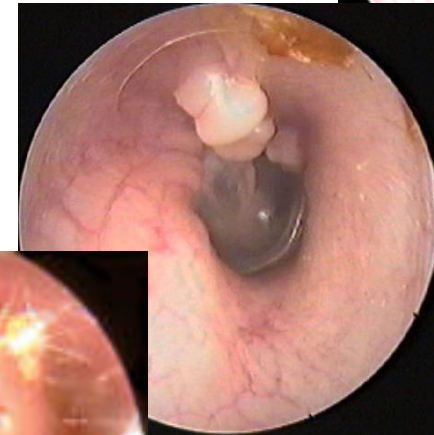
Malignant otitis externa

- Skull base osteomyelitis
- M.o
- Immunocompromised pt
- 3 stages
- Presentation
- Treatment
 - Curetting granulation tissue
 - daily packing with ribbon gauze impregnated with gentamycin ointment
 - IV antibiotics as 3rd generation cephalosporin , ticarcillin & using oral ciprofloxacin (for 6 wks duration) is very effective .
 - Surgery rarely required



Osteoma

- Swimmer ear
- Single or multiple exostosis
- Conservative or surgery



Malignant tumors

- BCC
- SCC



Conclusions

The commonest inflammatory condition affecting the external ear is diffuse otitis externa, but don't miss the Malignant otitis externa in immune compromised patients.

References

- Scott Brown text book
- Logan's turner text book